

Safflower Oil

How to rebuild your dog's skin barrier and stop the itch.

How to Apply (Topical Is Best)

Topical use works best because the oil absorbs directly into the damaged skin where it is needed. For one small red area, rub a little directly onto the spot. For a dog that is itchy all over, apply it along the spine, the same way you would apply a spot-on flea treatment, parting the fur in a few spots so it reaches the skin.

Topical Dose by Weight

Your Dog's Weight	Apply Along Spine	How Often
Up to 20 lbs	1 teaspoon	Once a day
20 to 40 lbs	2 teaspoons	Once a day
40 to 60 lbs	1 tablespoon	Once a day
60 lbs and up	1 to 1.5 tablespoons	Once a day

What to Buy

- Cold-pressed safflower oil (highest linoleic acid content)
- High-linoleic type, not high-oleic, check the label
- Organic if available, kept in a cool dark place
- Sunflower oil works as a backup but is less effective

TOPICAL FIRST: Safflower oil is high in omega-6. Giving large amounts BY MOUTH long term can throw off your dog's omega-3 to omega-6 balance and may worsen inflammation. Use it on the skin. Only add a small oral dose if your vet approves, and reduce other fats in the diet to make room for it.

GIVE IT TIME: Skin barrier repair is slow. Expect 3 to 6 weeks of daily use before you see a real drop in itching. Pair with omega-3 fish oil by mouth for the best balance.